Derek Misler

Senior Software Engineer

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Front-end engineer at Docker based in Arlington, VA. I build AI agent tooling and AI-powered developer tools, from design-system infrastructure to enterprise desktop workflows, using React, TypeScript, and accessibility-first practices.

Experience

Senior Software Engineer, Docker

Feb 2024 to Present

- Led engineering across Docker's AI agent platform and Docker Desktop admin experiences (including Gordon 2.0, Docker's AI assistant shipping to millions of Desktop users), establishing the team's performance optimization standards across the product surface.
- Rebuilt the shared Electron-based UI platform for Docker's agent tooling (monorepo, CI/CD, design system integration, hot reload, test infrastructure); the shadcn + Tailwind architectural decision made here resolved a company-wide component framework debate and was adopted as the standard across Docker's entire frontend codebase.
- Delivered secure telemetry pipelines (event schema design, CI validation, dashboards) to improve observability and product decision-making.
- Embedded with Docker's AI Governance team as the sole frontend lead on one of the company's top priorities, supporting a major enterprise contract. Ramped on an unfamiliar codebase in days, took ownership of a stalled workstream, and moved the team from behind schedule to ahead of it.
- Built and rolled out docker-agent-action (Docker's AI-assisted PR review platform) across 100+ repositories and every engineering team; hardened its security posture, open-sourced it under Apache 2.0, and built self-serve onboarding so any team can adopt without manual setup.
- Took over ownership, unblocked, and shipped Bulk Deployment for Docker Desktop, enabling enterprise IT teams to configure and distribute Docker at scale across platforms.
- Integrated Docker Hub catalog search/launch into Docker Desktop to reduce workflow friction and improve discoverability.
- Led front-end architecture for an enterprise Insights dashboard, referenced in customer adoption and sales enablement outcomes.
- Without any mandate, authored a comprehensive ownership and risk map of the entire docker/frontends monorepo, surfacing orphaned platform infrastructure, single-engineer bottlenecks on security-critical auth and IAM surfaces, and an estimated 15-25 engineer-hours/week of structural debt. The analysis is now driving leadership's evaluation of a dedicated frontend platform team.

Senior Front-End Platform Engineer, Patreon

Jan 2022 to Dec 2023

- Designed an incremental migration pattern to move features safely without blocking product delivery, enabling staged rollout and parallel work.
- Led the front-end workstream and partnered with backend platform + infrastructure teams, delivering an immediate 55% reduction in LCP (primary KR metric).
- Senior engineer on the Front-End Platform team driving a large-scale migration from a Flask/React multi-page app and in-house SSR to Next.js.
- Built rollout and reliability guardrails: percentage-based feature flags, alerting/triage workflows, and dashboards to monitor regressions.
- Drove quality and maintainability upgrades: TypeScript adoption, linting standards, and front-end documentation practices.
- Modernized testing from minimal coverage/Enzyme to React Testing Library + Cypress, including running smoke/e2e in dev and on PRs (not only at deploy time).
- Mentored junior engineers and interns; created and led "Front-End 101" onboarding for new engineers and served as a high-volume interviewer.
- Improved state and form architecture by migrating from Redux to Jotai and building accessible form/validation primitives integrated with the component library (React Hook Form).

Senior Engineer, then Tech Lead, Cadre

Mar 2020 to Jan 2022

- Unified decoupled SPA and third-party marketing site into cohesive Django/React app; migrated front-end to monorepo.
- Built custom server-rendering with Webpack, React, and Node.js for marketing site.
- Led internal design system built on Base Web component library (open-source contributor).
- Mentored full-stack engineers using Agile and Shape Up methodologies.

Staff Front-End/Mobile Engineer, Transfix

Jan 2016 to Mar 2020

- First front-end engineer; established web and mobile architecture, rebuilding Android/iOS apps in React Native.
- Evolved web stack from Rails → Aurelia → React/Redux; developed internal library for web, mobile, and shared NPM modules.
- Implemented CI/CD with CircleCI, defined linting/testing standards, and led creation of internal component library.
- Rebuilt public site from WordPress to Jade templates, later migrating to 11ty.js.

Web Manager, Developer, Photographer, Asheville Convention & Visitors Bureau

Dec 2010 to Dec 2015

- Primary developer for web presence; built first mobile site and responsive blog theme in .NET environment.
- Redesigned marketing site twice, evolving from ColdFusion to Node/MongoDB with custom JS templating.
- Designed and built two award-winning interactive web experiences using Node and AngularJS.

Skills

- **Architecture & Platform:** Front-End Architecture, Design Systems, Monorepo Architecture, Platform DX, API Design, Performance Optimization, Scalable UI Patterns
- **AI & Agent Systems:** AI Agent Development, LLM Integration, Agent Orchestration, Prompt Engineering, Agent Security & Guardrails, AI-Powered Developer Tools
- **Product & UX:** UI/UX Design, Responsive Design, Typography & Layout, Accessibility (WCAG), Interaction Design, Design Tokens, Visual Hierarchy
- **Quality & Delivery:** Developer Experience, Testing Strategy, CI/CD Workflows, Observability-Driven Iteration, Production Readiness

Tools

- **Core Stack:** TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Electron, Node.js, Web Components
- **Platform & Infra:** Docker, Nx, Monorepos, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, CloudFront, S3, Telemetry Pipelines
- **AI & Agents:** OpenAI API, Claude API, Tool Calling, Agent Workflows, LLM Orchestration, Prompt Engineering, Agent Security
- **Dev Tooling & Quality:** Vite, Webpack, Jest, Vitest, React Testing Library, Playwright, Cypress, Storybook, Chromatic, Biome, ESLint, Prettier
- **Observability & Ops:** Sigma, DataDog, Sentry, Structured Logging, Metrics & Dashboards
- **Languages & Ecosystem:** Go, Python, Remix, Astro, React Native, Redux Toolkit, Jotai
- **Design:** Figma, Tailwind CSS, Adobe Creative Cloud, Base Web, Shadcn/UI

Education

BFA, Graphic Design, Appalachian State University

Studied graphic design with a focus on web, typography, and layout. Built early front-end skills through web design courses and interactive media projects, including Flash/ActionScript game development.